Explain disciplinary language and hidden norms

Teaching

TEACHING ONE-PAGE PRACTICAL GUIDE

WHAT IS THIS FOR?

Help students learn how the discipline thinks and communicates instead of expecting them to infer it.

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

Help students learn how the discipline thinks and communicates instead of expecting them to infer it.

WHAT DOES THIS LOOK LIKE?

Key disciplinary terms, participation norms and tacit rules are explained rather than assumed.

WHAT CAN I DO?

- Name unfamiliar terms when they first appear.
- Model how an expert approaches an unfamiliar problem.
- Explain the purpose behind conventions, not only the rule.
- Teach the digital tools and information practices students are expected to use.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

Before asking students to “critically evaluate”, an educator models the process and names the questions an expert is asking at each step.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

For the next teaching period, our team will: name unfamiliar terms when they first appear; model how an expert approaches an unfamiliar problem. We will review student feedback and adjust if needed.

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UQ teaching practices

Students as Partners

Inclusive practice

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